about the same time. That resulted in a crackdown on ragging, one of many such short-lived crackdowns. The outcome of this was that it was decided that there should be exclusive first-termer squadrons with only a few fifth- and sixth-term cadet-appointment holders to keep an eye on them. Alpha, Echo and Juliet Squadrons were earmarked for this, primarily because they faced the Cadets' Mess and thus more visible. The cadets of these three squadrons were equitably distributed among the others, and thus, along with JV Singh, Ashok Mukherjee and Nalin Tandon, I landed up in Lima Squadron. As a result, my course, 56th, ended up being the squadron juniors once again, just as we were relishing the prospects of becoming seniors. This arrangement of isolating the first-termers was fine on paper, but they couldn't be isolated from the overall environment. Accordingly, yet another change that took place was the creation of an NDA Wing at Ghorpadi, in Pune itself, where the first-termers would be sent to ease them in. So, the 58th Course reported to the NDA Wing, and since there was now spare capacity at Khadakwasla, all the cadets at the NDA Wing at the OTS, Madras were transferred here and the Wing at Madras shut down. All the cadets who had been distributed to other squadrons as part of the earlier reorganization went back to their original squadrons, but for some reason, the four of us remained in Lima. With the creation of additional infrastructure at Khadakwasla and the addition of Mike, November and Oscar Squadrons, the Wing at Ghorpadi was also subsequently shut down. The NDA now has Papa, Queen and Romeo squadrons also, taking the total up from the initial twelve to the current eighteen. During my tenure as the Chief, female cadets were admitted to the NDA for the first time. Interestingly, these female cadets who joined the NDA as part of the 120th course are housed in Romeo Squadron.

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